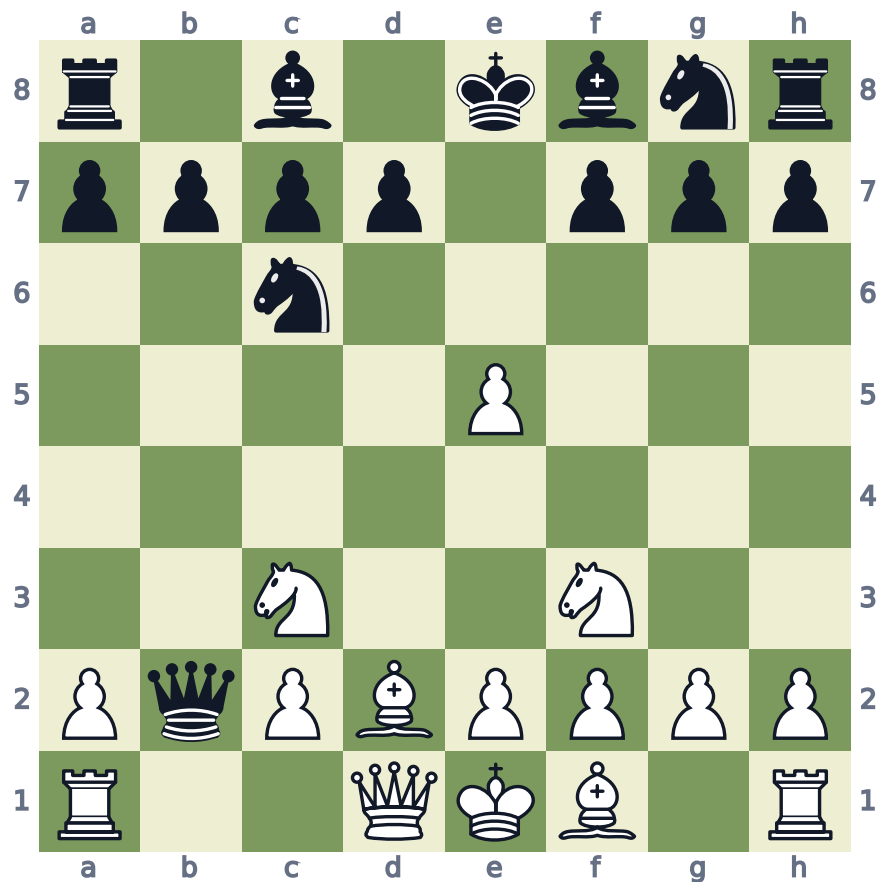


Gambits and Rare Defenses

Englund, Budapest, Albin, Chigorin, English Defense, Old Indian, and early sidelines



Neutralize surprise value with principles, exact forcing lines, and a safe destination for every unusual first-move response.

15 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Neutralize surprise value with principles, exact forcing lines, and a safe destination for every unusual first-move response.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 15 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Against gambits, secure development before trying to keep every pawn.

PRINCIPLE 2

Checks and queen attacks can be dangerous even when the gambit is objectively doubtful.

PRINCIPLE 3

Rare defenses often rely on one tactical point; identify it before routine development.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Return material when it removes the opponent's initiative.

PRINCIPLE 5

Transposition recognition saves memory and prevents move-order panic.

PRINCIPLE 6

A small stable advantage is a successful opening outcome.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|----------------------------|---|
| 01 | Englund Gambit | Meet queen checks first; material comes second. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | Budapest Gambit | Bf4 protects e5 while developing; Nbd2 answers the check safely. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | Albin Countergambit | Stop the passer, then attack it. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | Chigorin Defense | ...Nc6 blocks ...c5, so Black seeks piece pressure instead. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Baltic Defense | Qa4+ is the tactical reason an early ...Bf5 is not free. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | English Defense | The b7 bishop and ...f5 jointly attack e4. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Old Indian | The knight on d7 marks an Old Indian rather than a King's Indian. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Black Knights Tango | ...Nc6 before ...d5 can invite d5 or transpositions. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 9-15

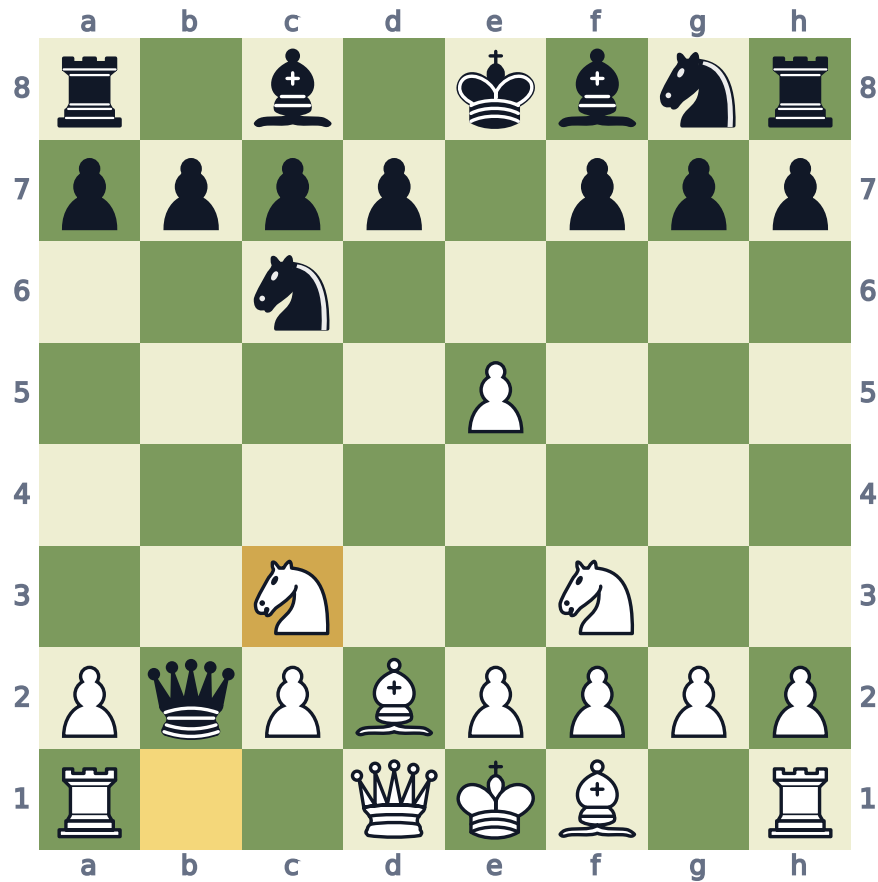
- | | | |
|-----------|----------------------------------|---|
| 09 | Modern Defense move order | Identify the pawn structure, not the opening label. |
| | | |
| 10 | Wade Defense | Take space, then defend it with pieces rather than more pawns. |
| | | |
| 11 | Early 1...c5 | 1...c5 usually asks whether White wants a Benoni with d5. |
| | | |
| 12 | 1...Nc6 | Chase the knight only when the center remains stable. |
| | | |
| 13 | 1...b5 Polish Defense | A flank pawn move gives White permission to claim the center, not to relax. |
| | | |
| 14 | 1...b6 | ...b6 becomes meaningful only through pressure on e4. |
| | | |
| 15 | 1...a6 | Against a slow flank move, occupy the center and develop. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Englund Gambit



COURSE LINE

1. d4 e5 2. dxe5 Nc6 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. Bf4 Qb4+ 5. Bd2 Qxb2 6. Nc3

WHITE'S IDEA

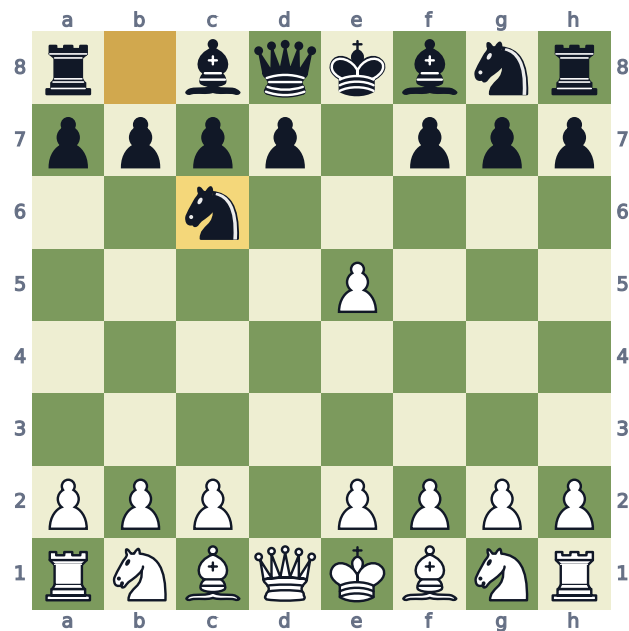
Develop with tempo and be ready to return the pawn to trap or displace the queen.

MAIN DANGER

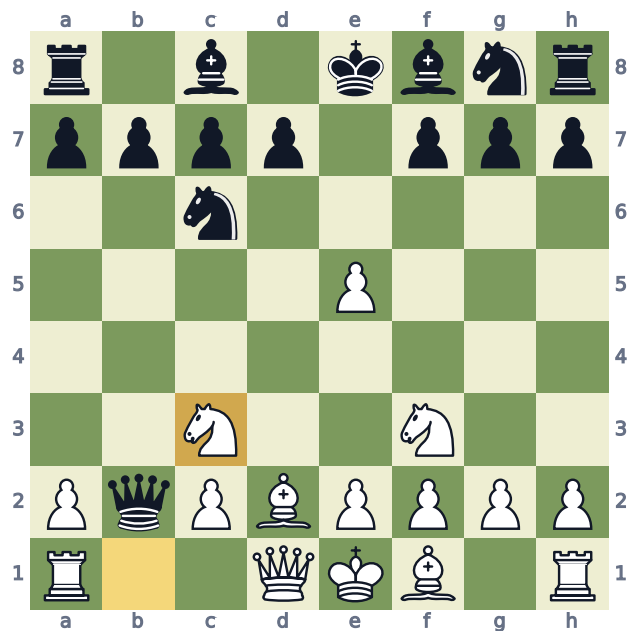
The b2-pawn is poisoned only if White knows the follow-up.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Meet queen checks first; material comes second.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

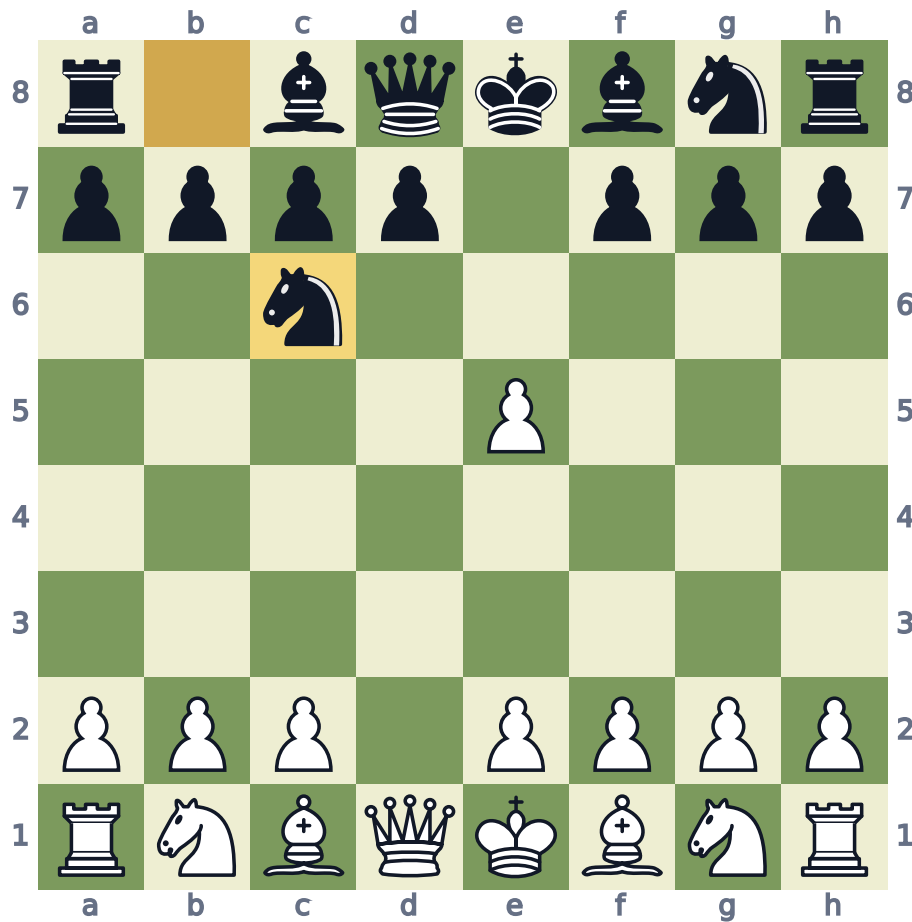
Position estimate: +1.83 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bb4 Rb1 2. Qa3 Nd5 3. Bxd2+ Qxd2 4. Kd8 e4 5. Qxa2 Qg5+

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Englund Gambit



YOUR TASK

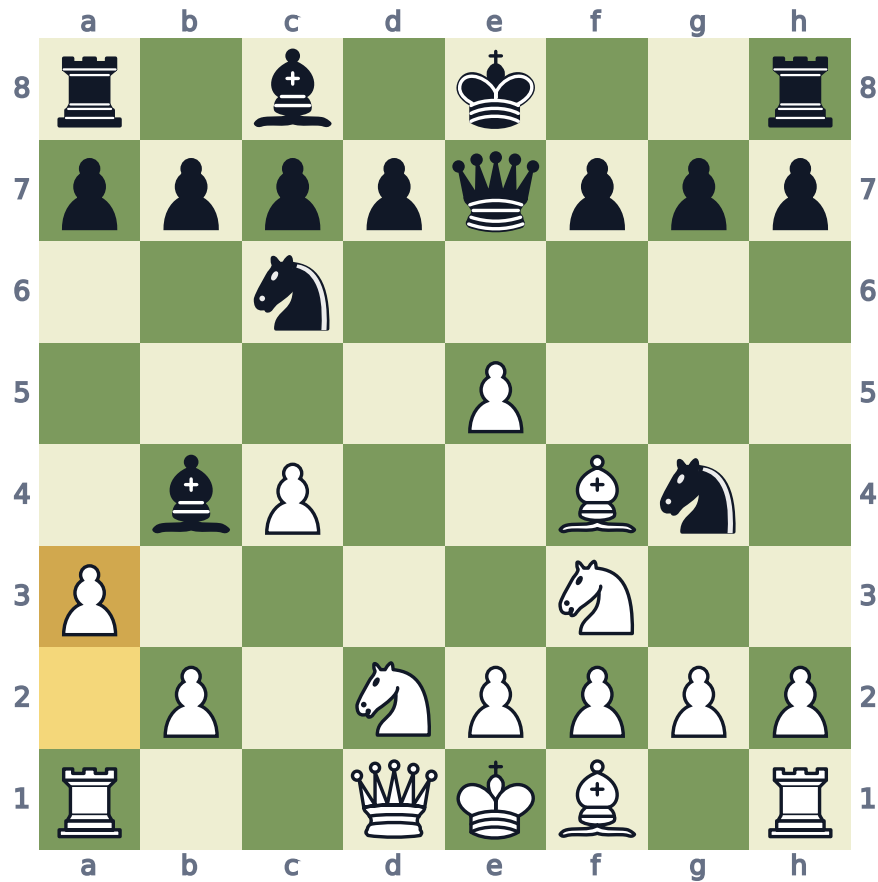
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Budapest Gambit



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 Ng4 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. Bf4 Bb4+ 6. Nbd2 Qe7 7. a3

WHITE'S IDEA

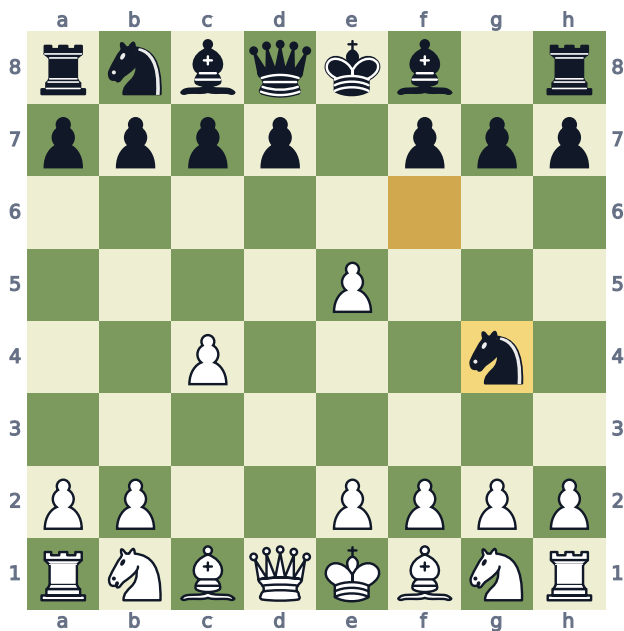
Develop, meet the check, and return e5 if it completes development.

MAIN DANGER

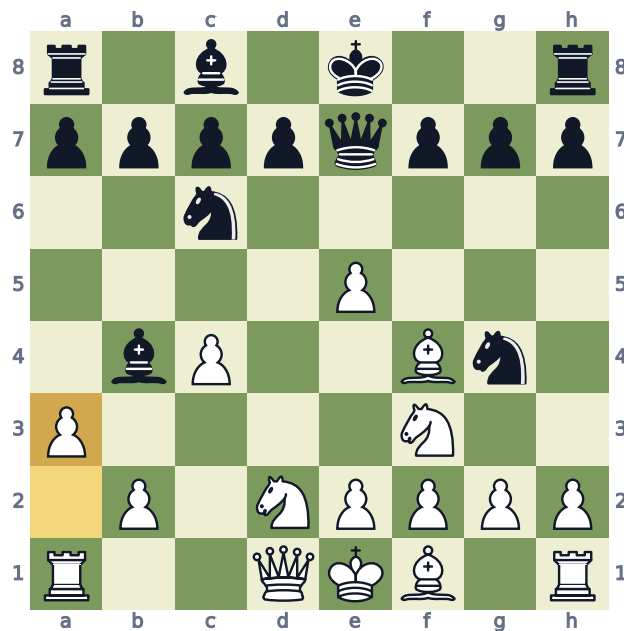
Trying to cling to e5 can leave the king in the center.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Bf4 protects e5 while developing; Nbd2 answers the check safely.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

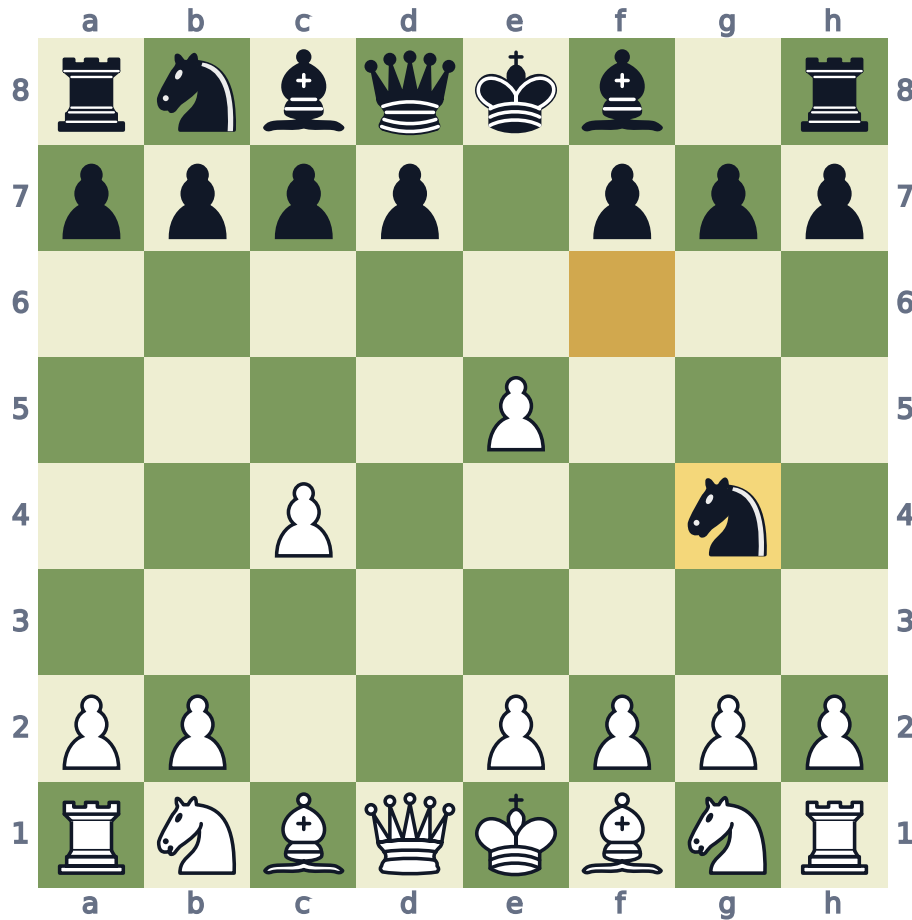
Position estimate: +0.59 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bxd2+ Qxd2 2. O-O Rc1 3. Nxe5 Nxe5 4. Nxe5 c5 5. Rd8 e4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Budapest Gambit



YOUR TASK

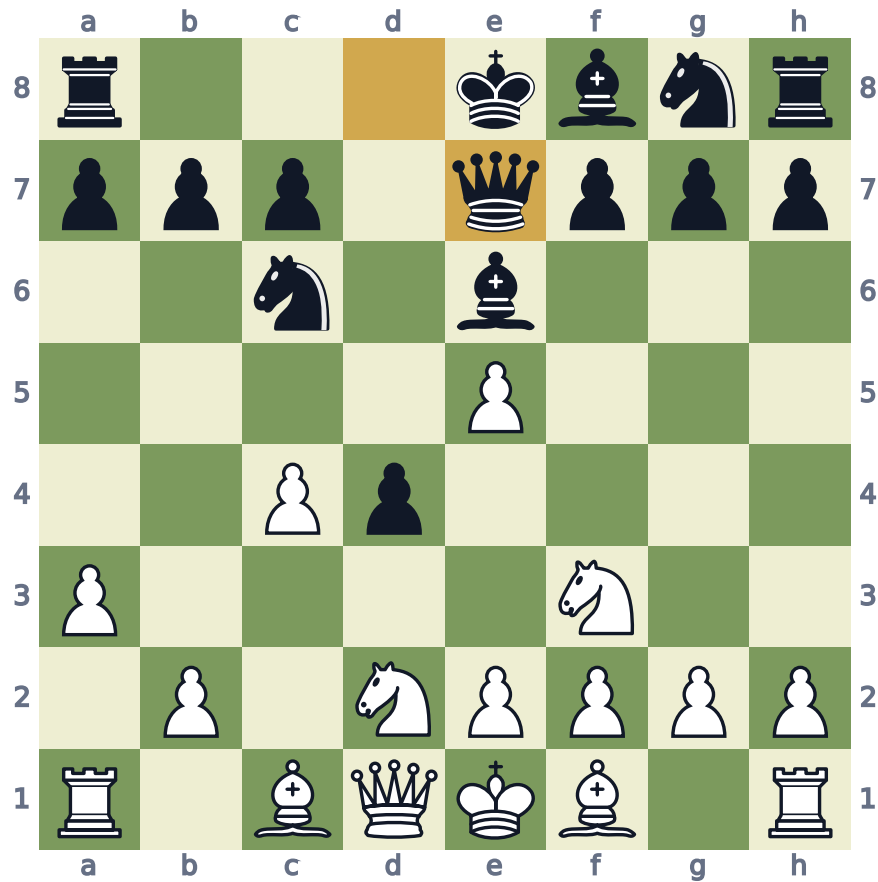
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Albin Countergambit



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e5 3. dxe5 d4 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. a3 Be6 6. Nbd2 Qe7

WHITE'S IDEA

Blockade d4 and complete development before trying to win the pawn.

MAIN DANGER

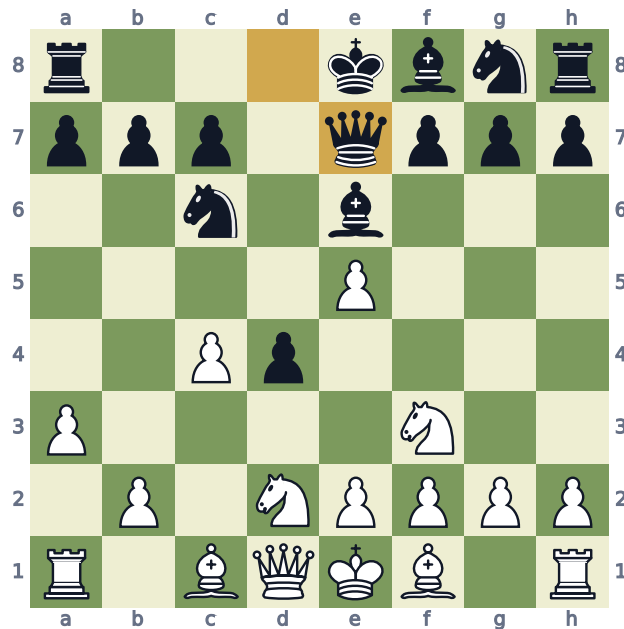
The advanced d4-pawn supports tactical checks and promotion tricks.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Stop the passer, then attack it.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.55 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. b4 Bg4 2. g3 Nxe5 3. Nxe5 Qxe5 4. h3 d3 5. hxg4 Qxa1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Albin Countergambit



YOUR TASK

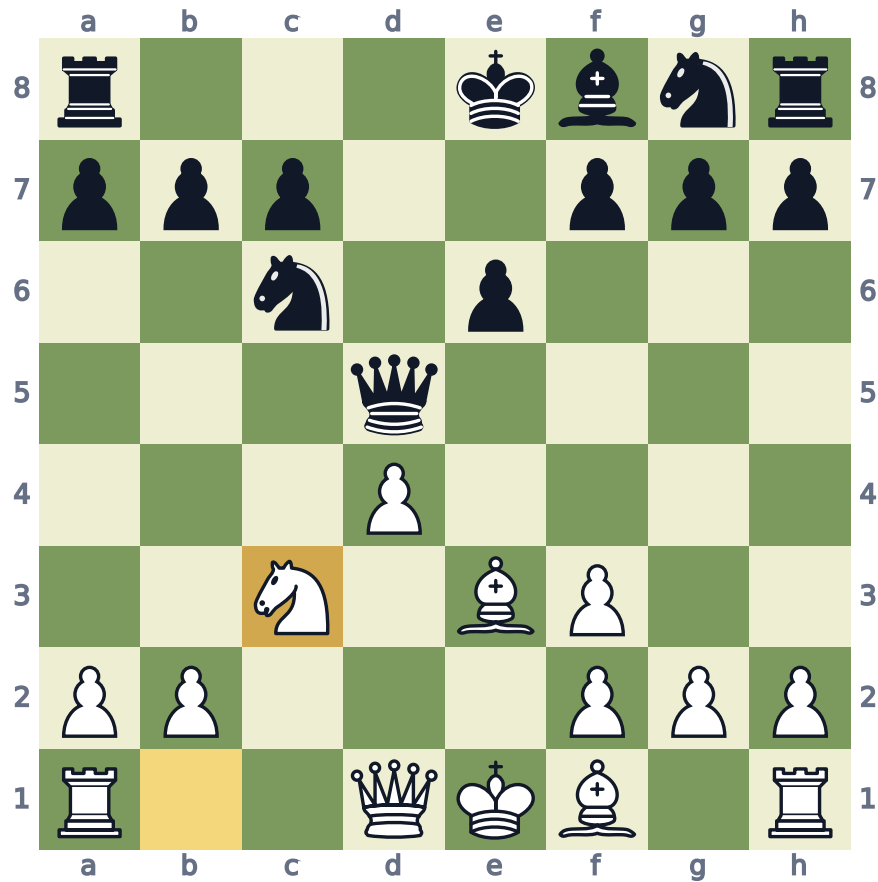
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Chigorin Defense



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 Nc6 3. Nf3 Bg4 4. cxd5 Bxf3 5. exf3 Qxd5 6. Be3 e6 7. Nc3

WHITE'S IDEA

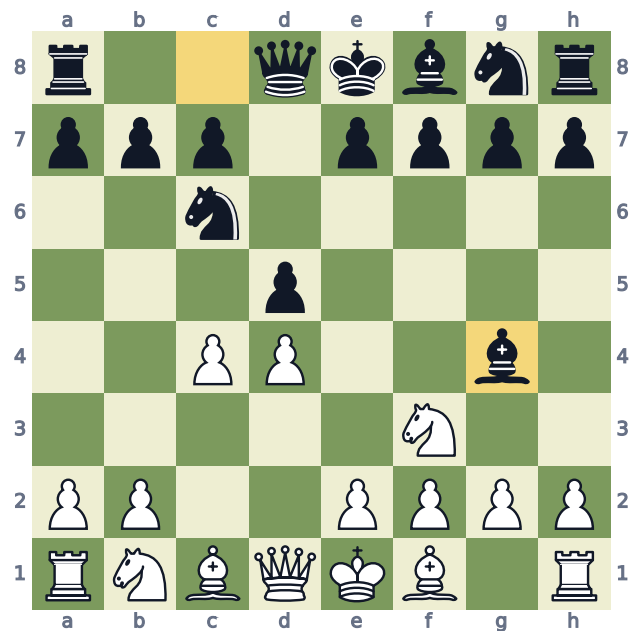
Use the bishop pair and central space after forcing Black's queen to work.

MAIN DANGER

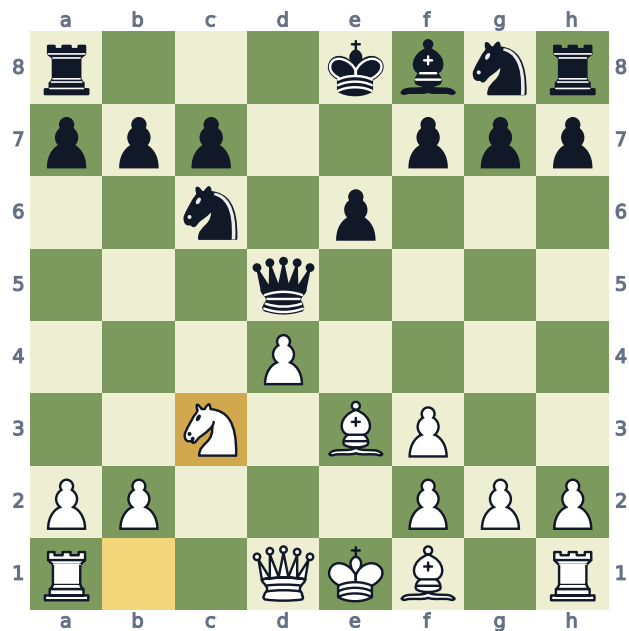
Doubled pawns require active pieces to justify them.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Nc6 blocks ...c5, so Black seeks piece pressure instead.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

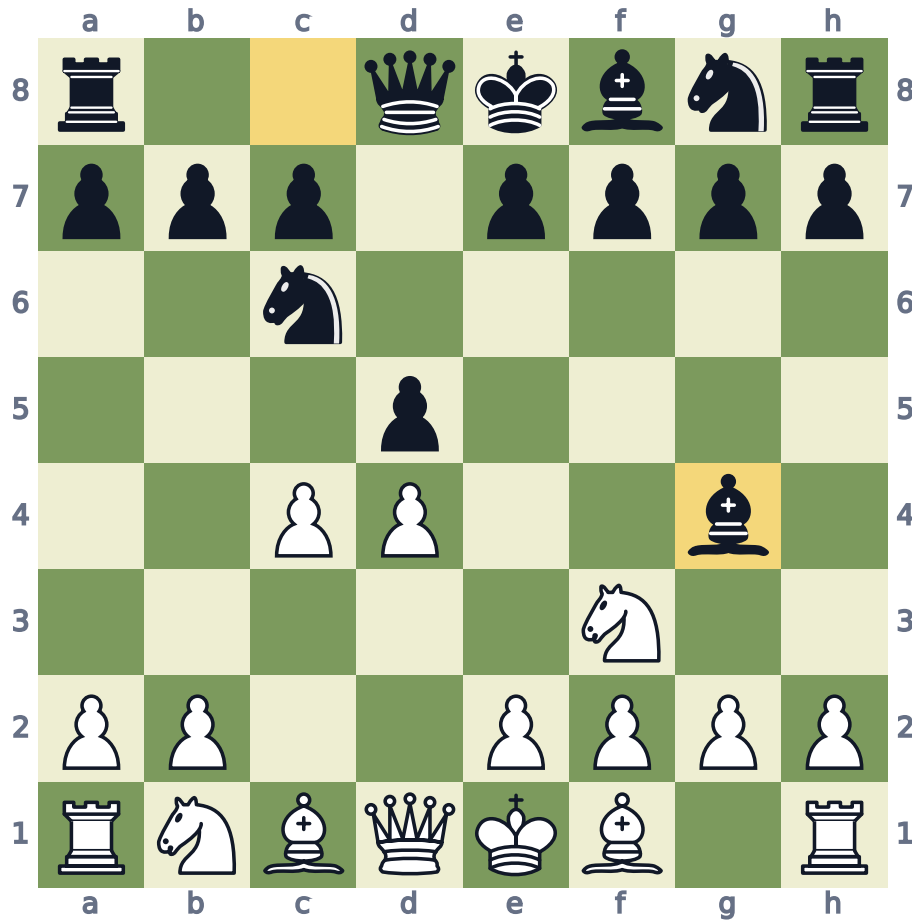
Position estimate: +0.43 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qd6 a3 2. Nf6 Qc2 3. Nd5 Nxd5 4. Qxd5 O-O-O 5. O-O-O Bc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Chigorin Defense



YOUR TASK

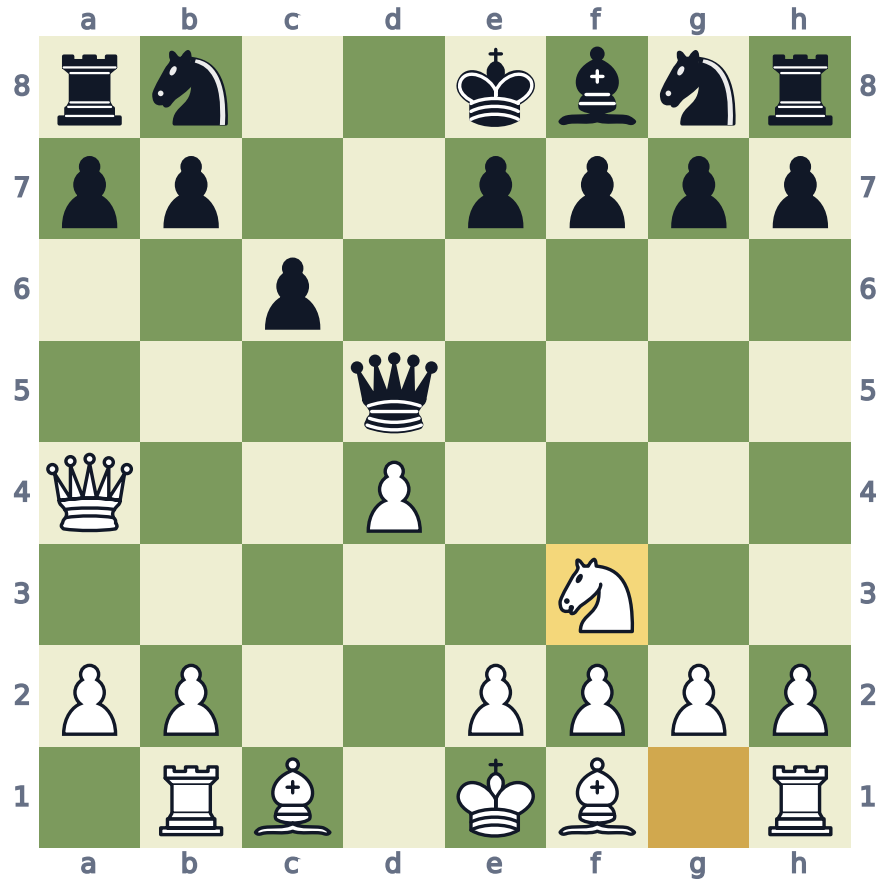
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Baltic Defense



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 Bf5 3. cxd5 Bxb1 4. Qa4+ c6 5. Rxb1 Qxd5 6. Nf3

WHITE'S IDEA

Exploit the early bishop move with a forcing check and development.

MAIN DANGER

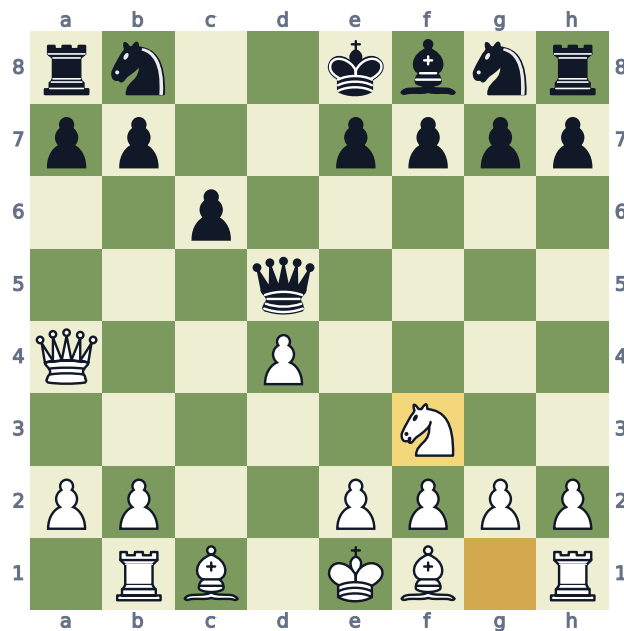
The rook on b1 can be exposed if the b-file opens.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Qa4+ is the tactical reason an early ...Bf5 is not free.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.71 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nd7 e3 2. Qf5 Ra1 3. e5 Bd2 4. Bd6 dxe5 5. Nxe5 Nxe5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Baltic Defense



YOUR TASK

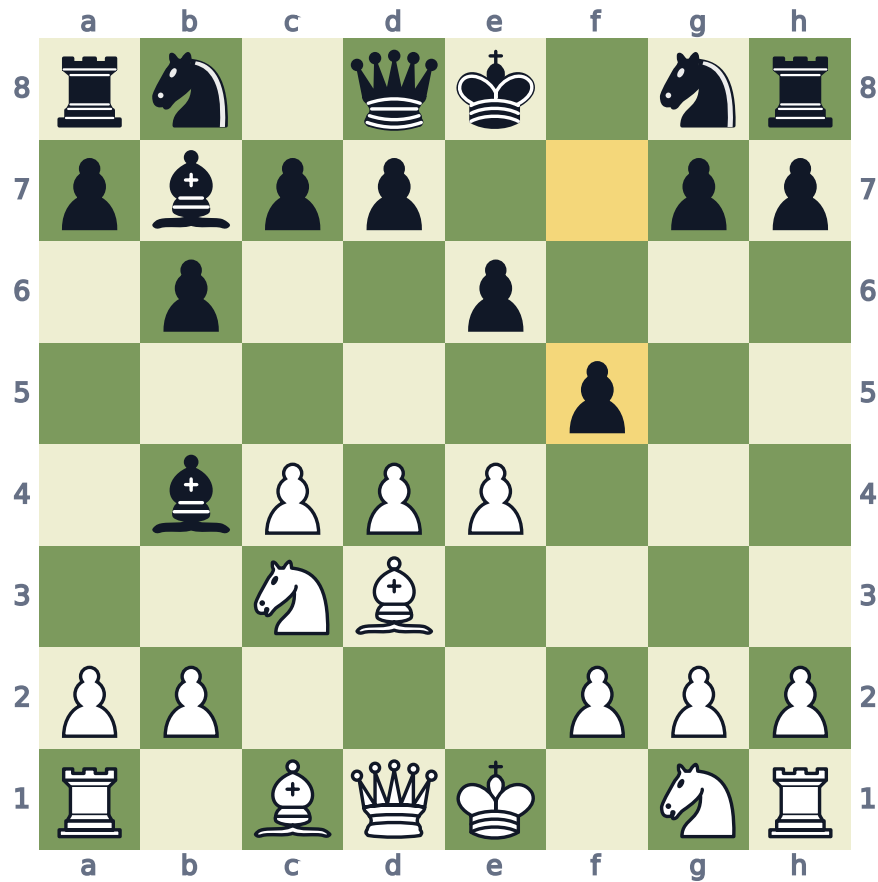
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

English Defense



COURSE LINE

1. d4 e6 2. c4 b6 3. Nc3 Bb7 4. e4 Bb4 5. Bd3 f5

WHITE'S IDEA

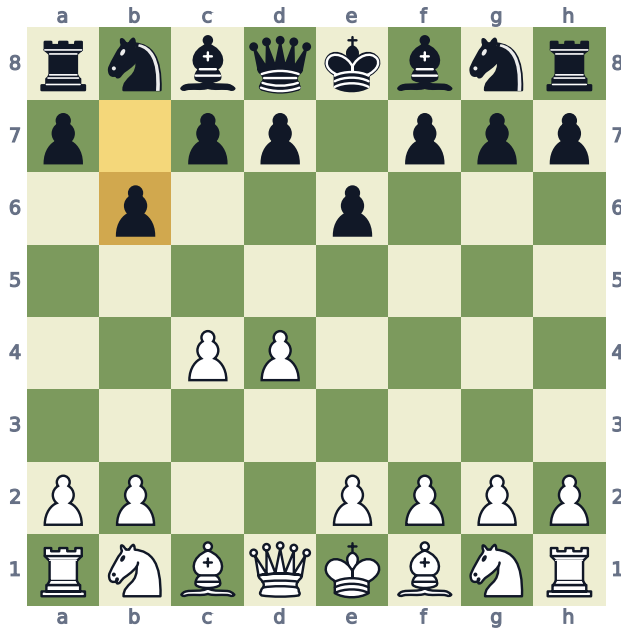
Build the center but respect pressure on e4 and the long diagonal.

MAIN DANGER

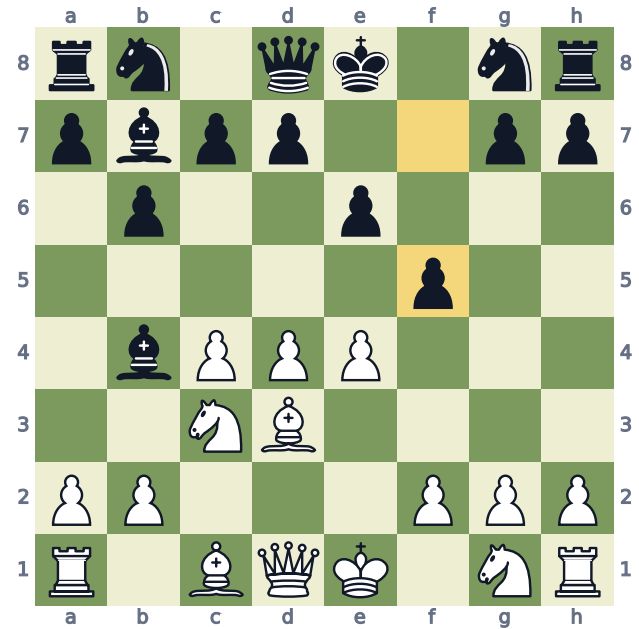
An overextended center can be attacked by ...f5 and ...Bxc3+.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The b7 bishop and ...f5 jointly attack e4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.65 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. f3 Qh4+ 2. g3 Qh5 3. exf5 Nc6 4. Ne2 Bxc3+ 5. bxc3 Qxf3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

English Defense



YOUR TASK

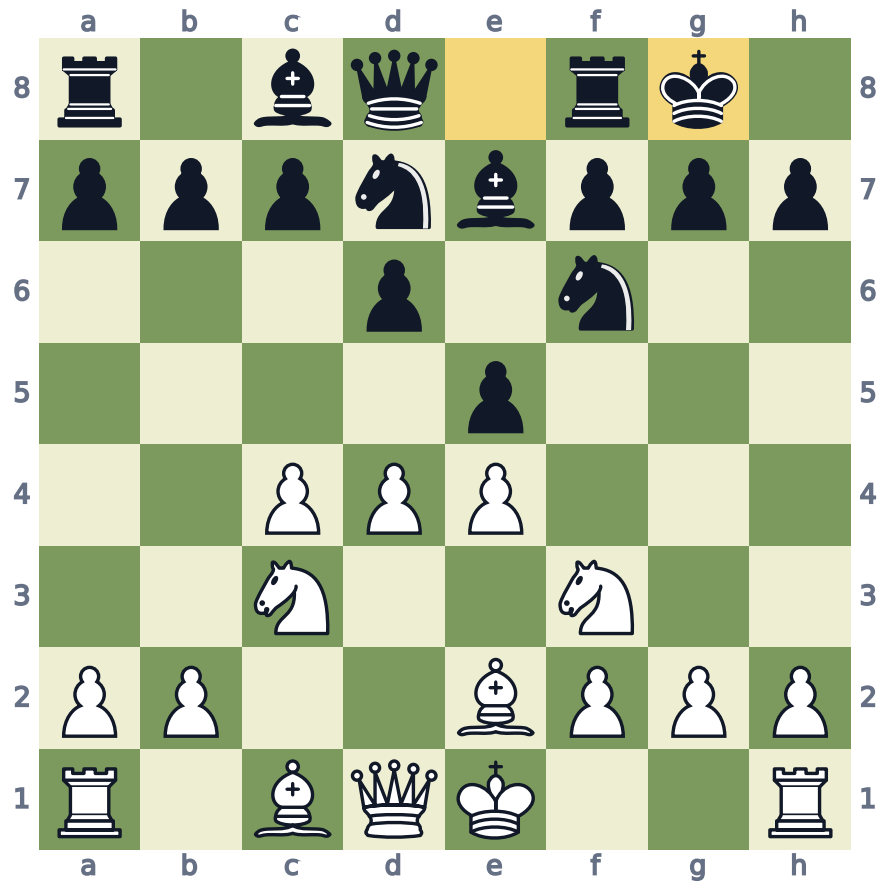
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Old Indian



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Nf3 Nbd7 5. e4 Be7 6. Be2 O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

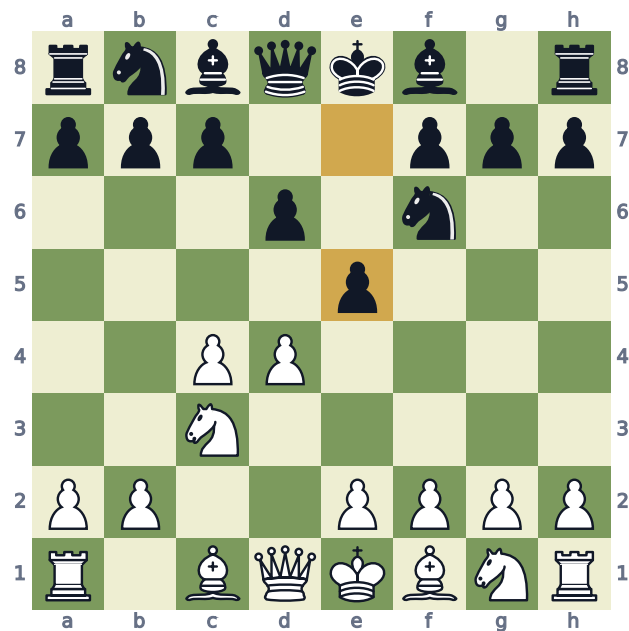
Build a classical center and use space before Black finds ...c6 or ...exd4.

MAIN DANGER

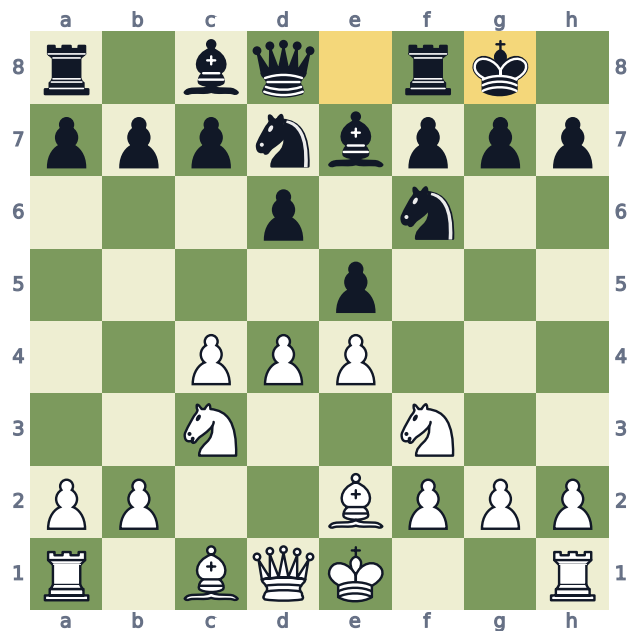
Closing too early can give Black an easy maneuvering plan.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The knight on d7 marks an Old Indian rather than a King's Indian.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

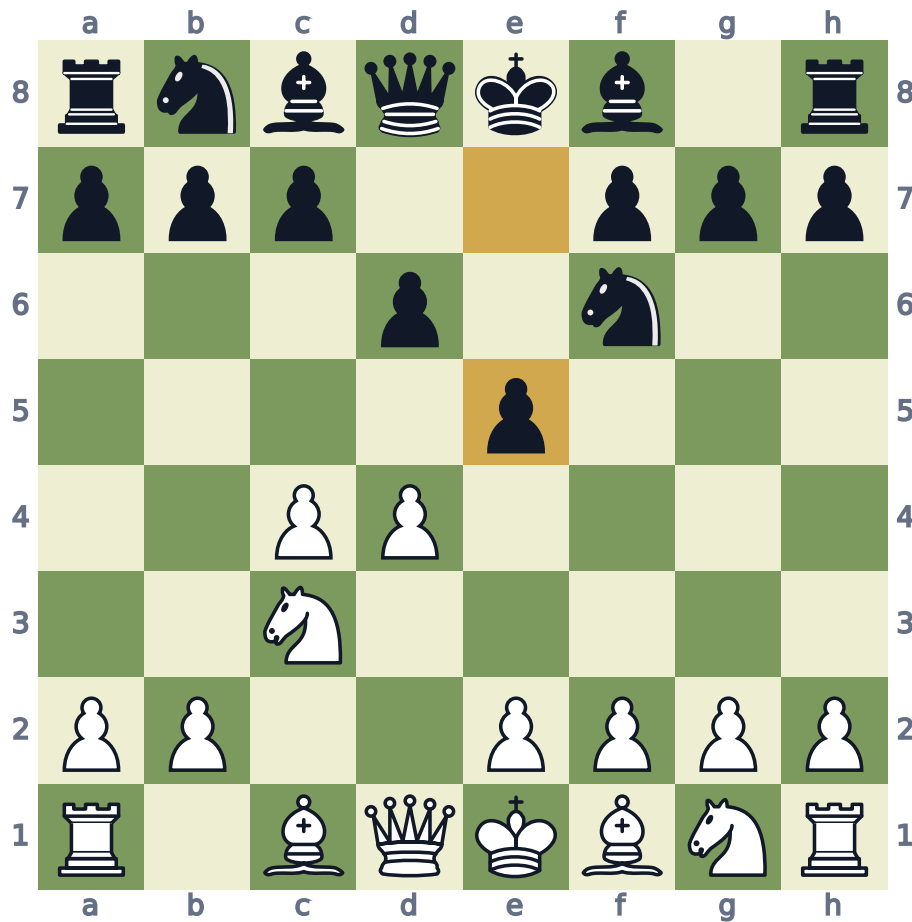
Position estimate: +0.91 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O Re8 2. Qc2 a5 3. h3 exd4 4. Nxd4 c6 5. Be3 Nc5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Old Indian



YOUR TASK

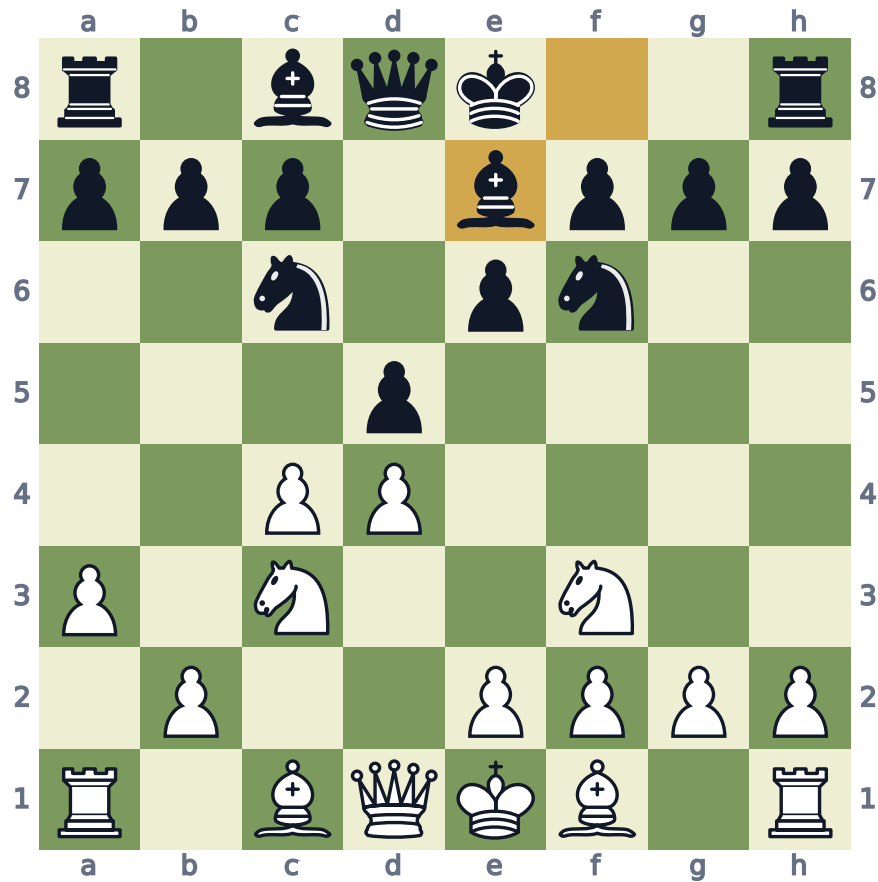
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Black Knights Tango



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 Nc6 3. Nf3 e6 4. a3 d5 5. Nc3 Be7

WHITE'S IDEA

Use a3 to question ...Bb4 and transpose into a favorable central setup.

MAIN DANGER

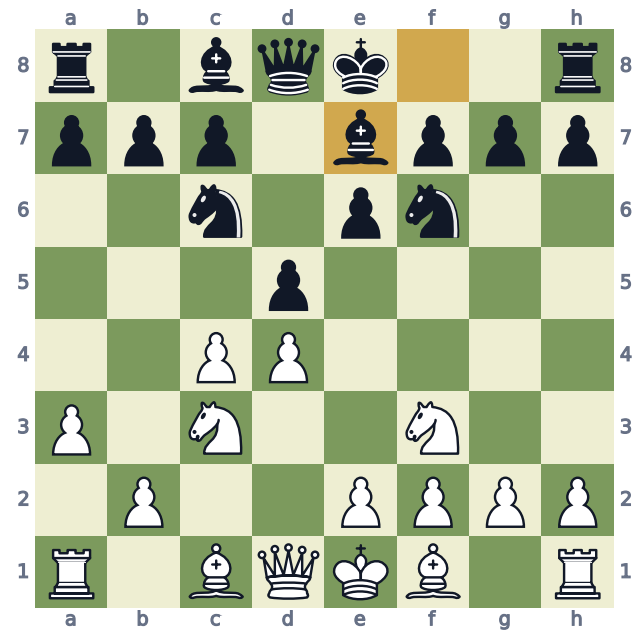
a3 is useful only when it prevents a concrete pin or prepares b4.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Nc6 before ...d5 can invite d5 or transpositions.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

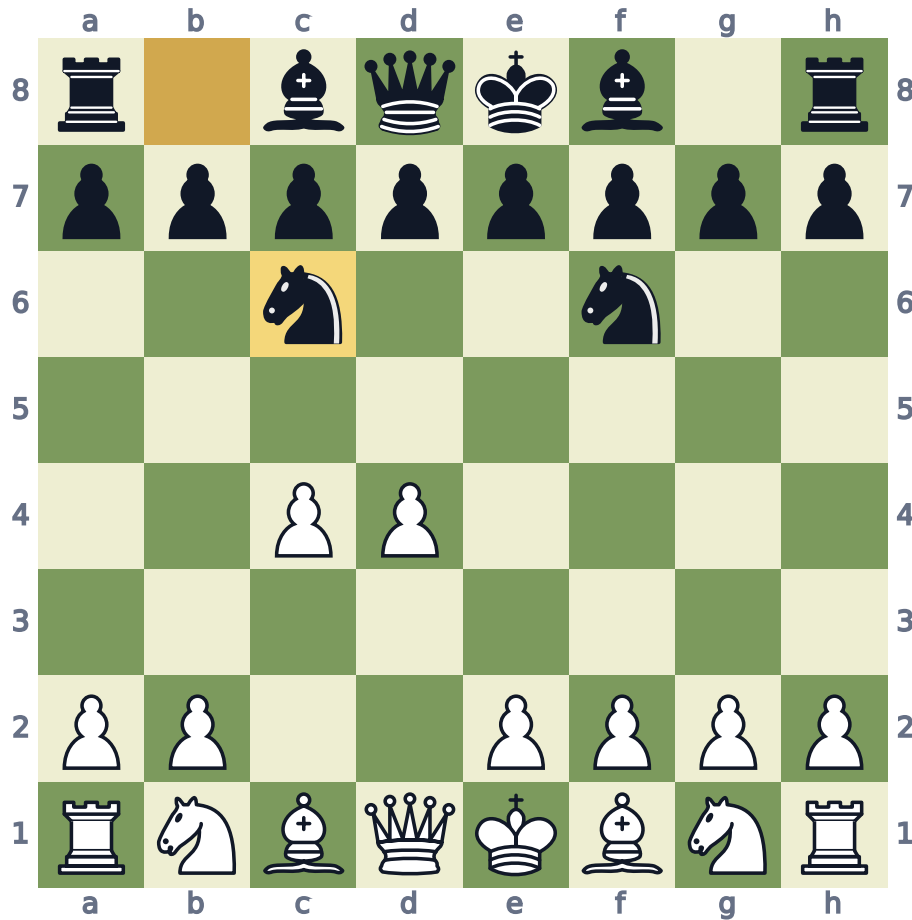
Position estimate: +0.67 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e3 Ne4 2. Nxe4 dxe4 3. Nd2 f5 4. b4 O-O 5. Be2 Bf6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Black Knights Tango



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 09

Modern Defense move order



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 Nf6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2

WHITE'S IDEA

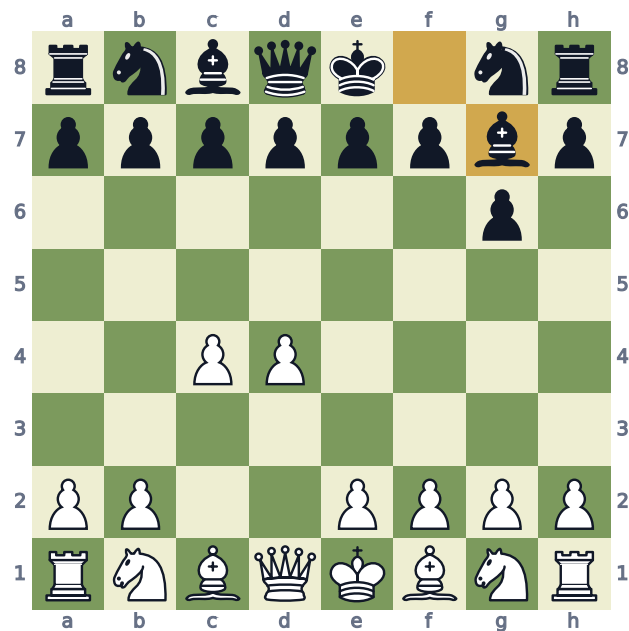
Transpose into the Classical King's Indian structure without allowing unnecessary tricks.

MAIN DANGER

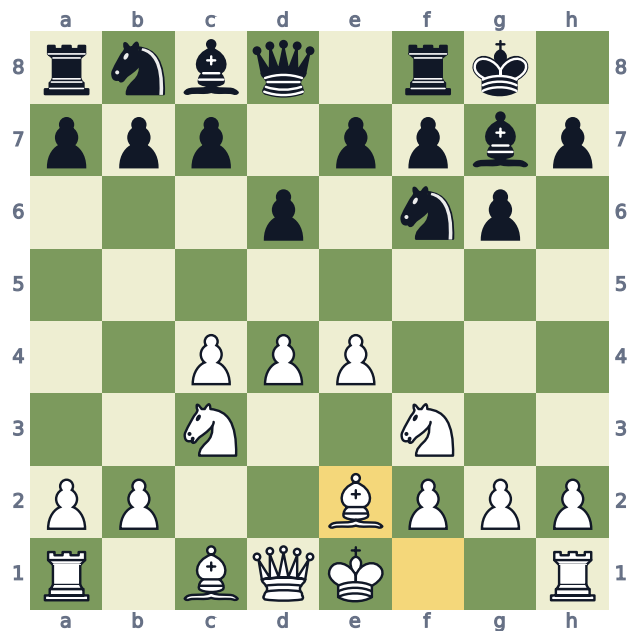
Black may delay ...Nf6 and strike with ...c5 or ...e5.

BRANCH LOGIC 09

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Identify the pawn structure, not the opening label.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.52 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 O-O 2. exd4 Nxd4 3. Nc6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 09

Modern Defense move order



YOUR TASK

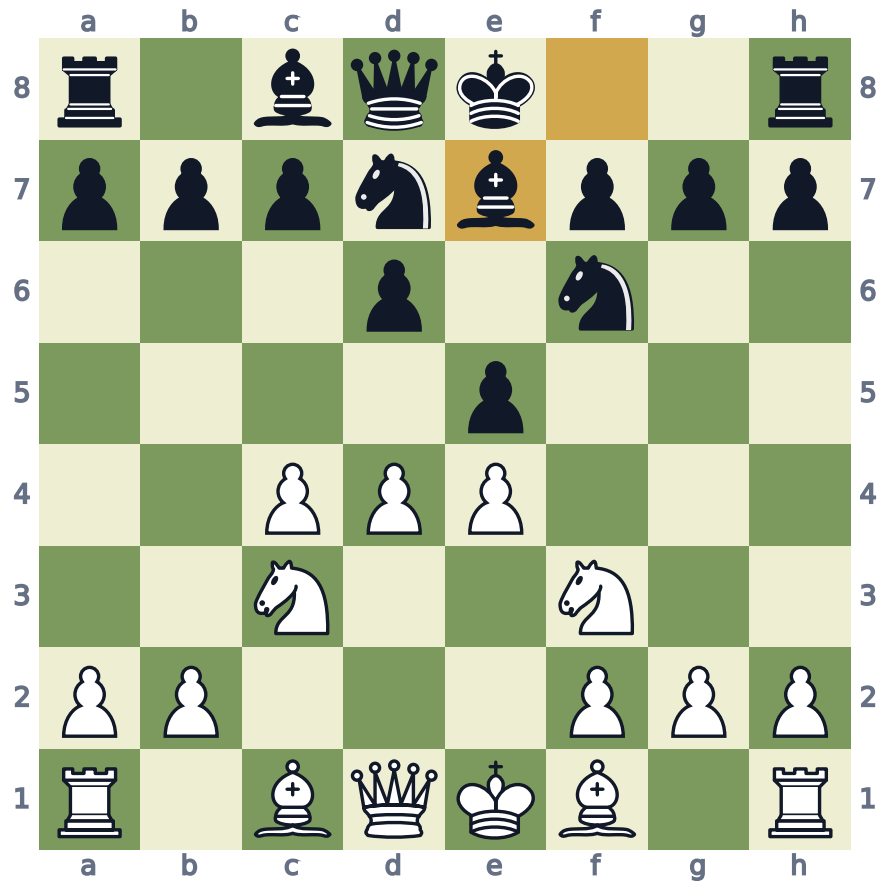
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 10

Wade Defense



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d6 2. c4 e5 3. Nc3 Nd7 4. Nf3 Ngf6 5. e4 Be7

WHITE'S IDEA

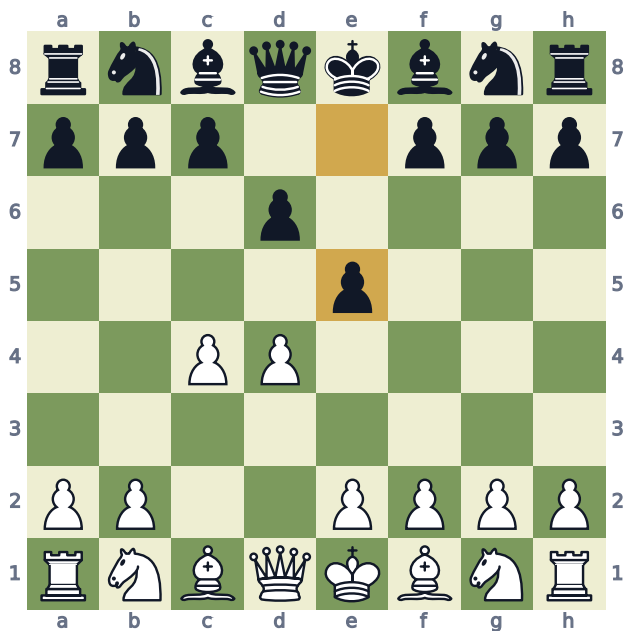
Occupy the center and complete development against a passive setup.

MAIN DANGER

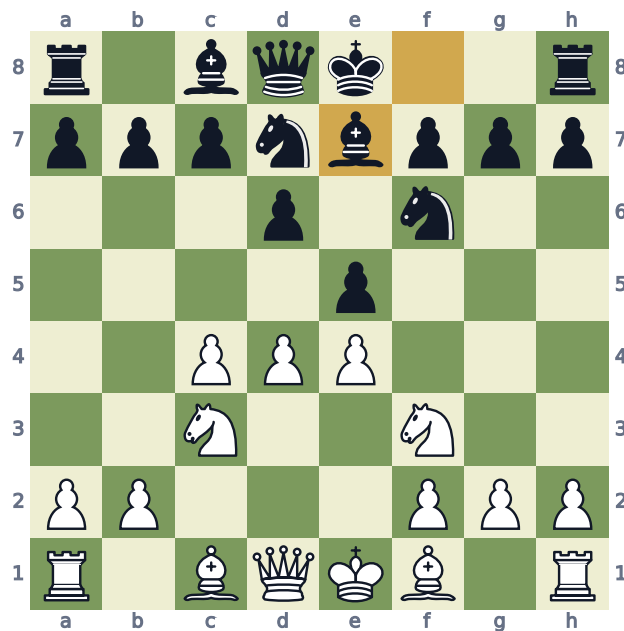
A large center can become a target after ...c6 and ...b5.

BRANCH LOGIC 10

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Take space, then defend it with pieces rather than more pawns.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

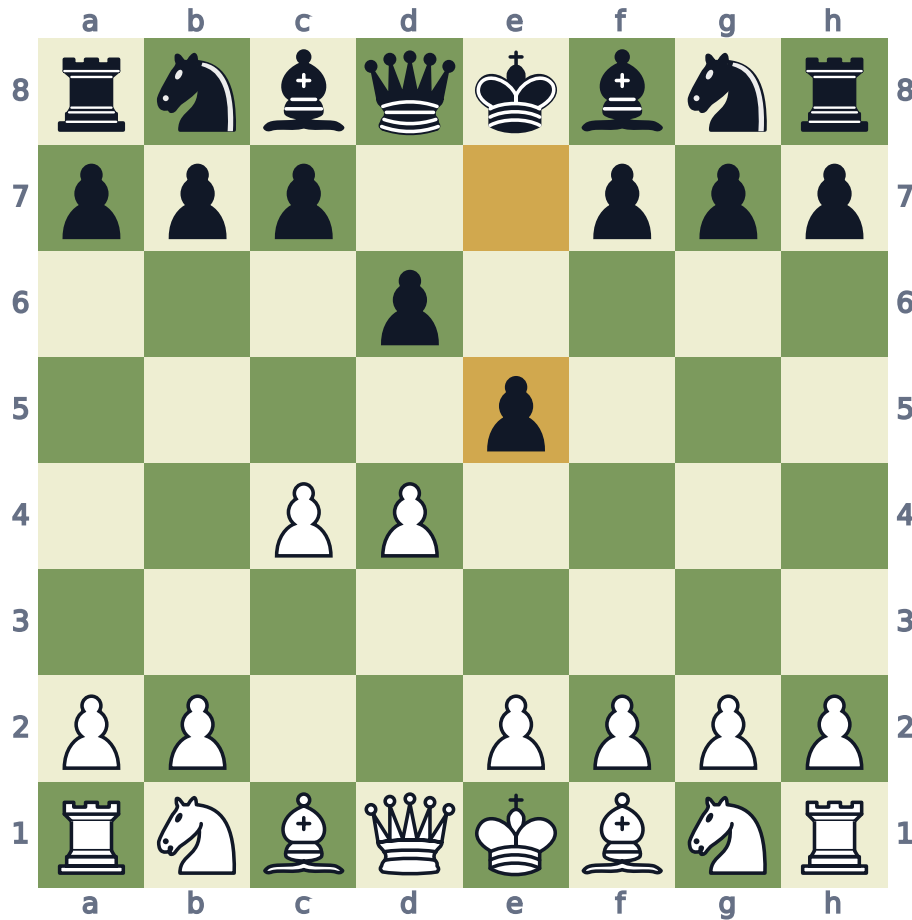
Position estimate: +0.83 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be2 O-O 2. Qc2 Re8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 10

Wade Defense



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 11

Early 1...c5



COURSE LINE

1. d4 c5 2. d5 Nf6 3. c4 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4

WHITE'S IDEA

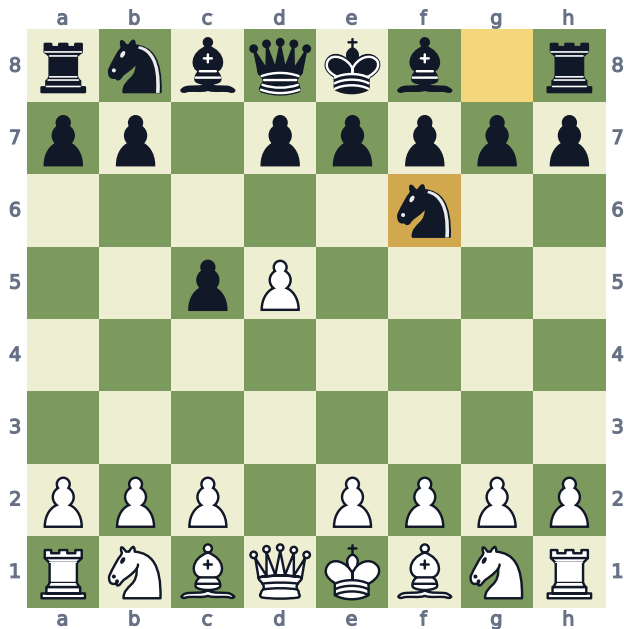
Transpose to the Benoni repertoire and use the same structure map.

MAIN DANGER

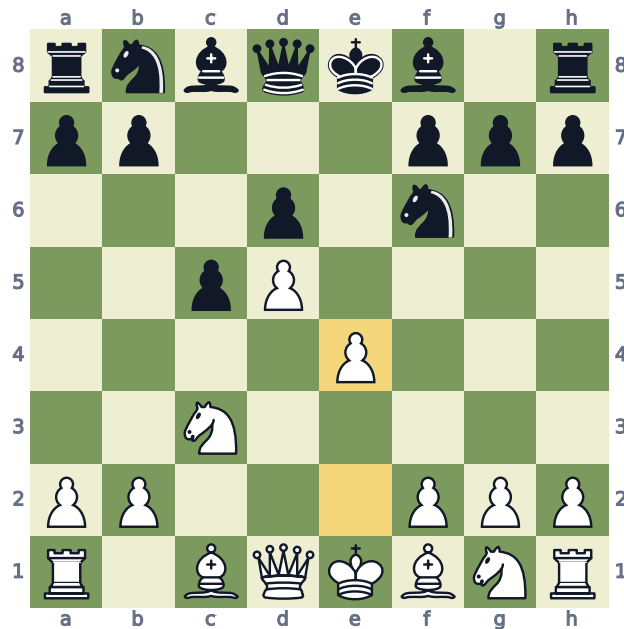
Do not improvise a separate system when a known transposition is available.

BRANCH LOGIC 11

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

1...c5 usually asks whether White wants a Benoni with d5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

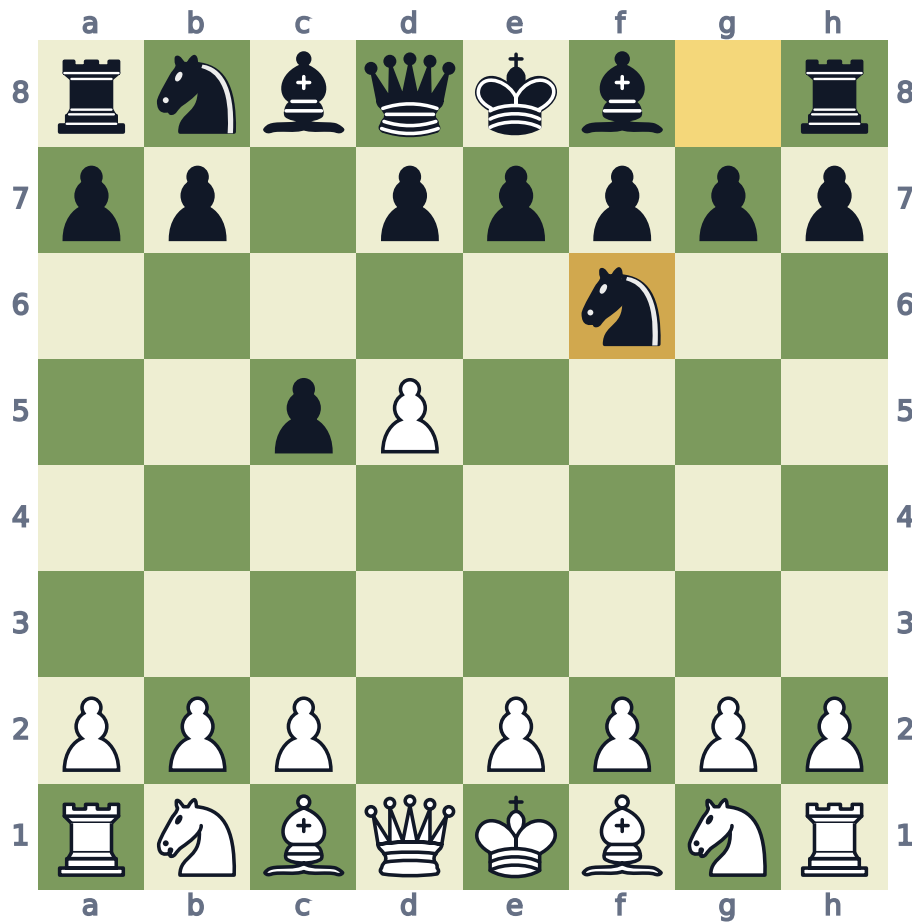
Position estimate: +0.84 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. g6 f4 2. Bg7 Bb5+ 3. Nfd7 Be2 4. O-O Nf3 5. Re8 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 11

Early 1...c5



YOUR TASK

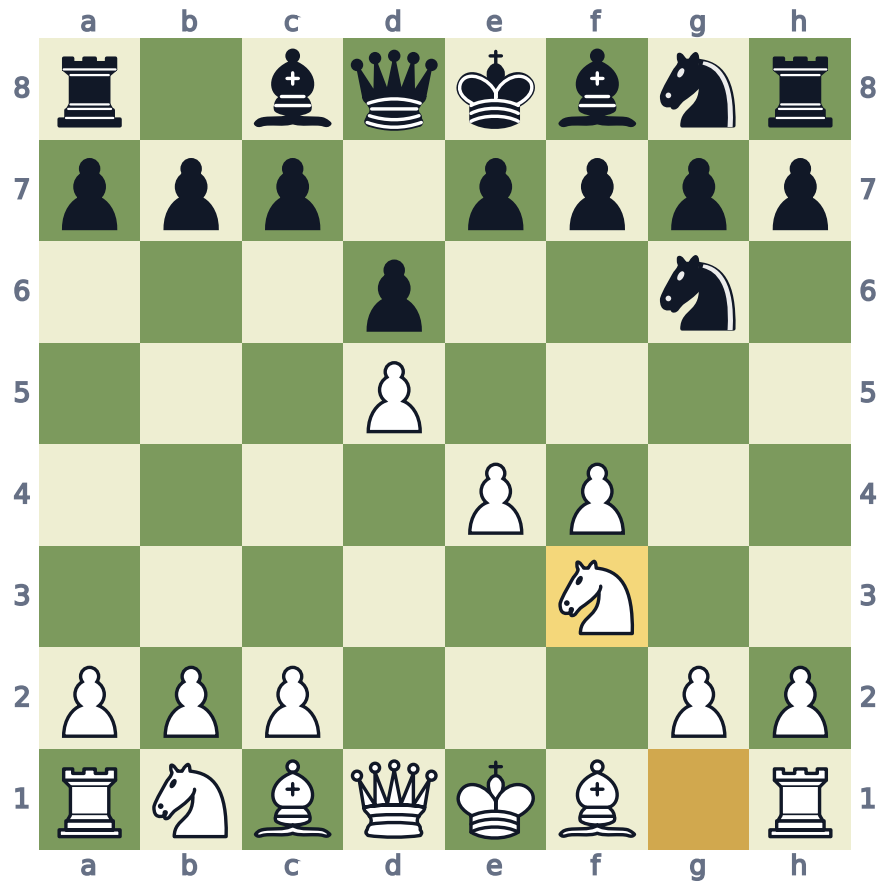
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 12

1...Nc6



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nc6 2. d5 Ne5 3. e4 d6 4. f4 Ng6 5. Nf3

WHITE'S IDEA

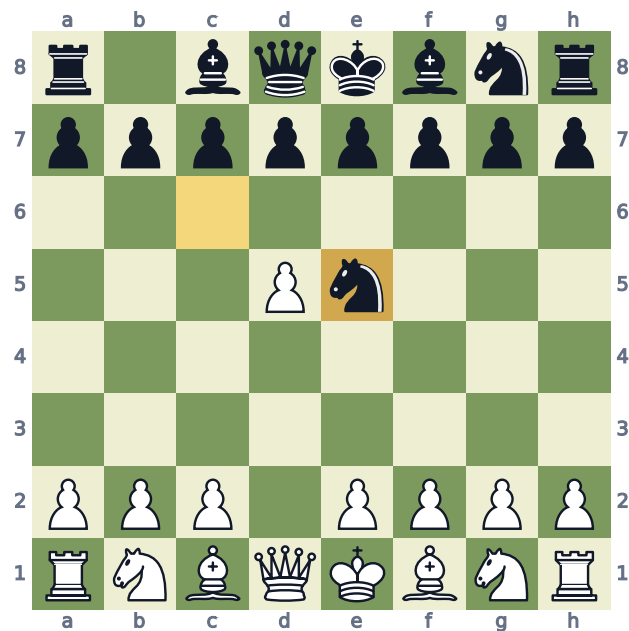
Gain space while developing and keep the pawn chain supported.

MAIN DANGER

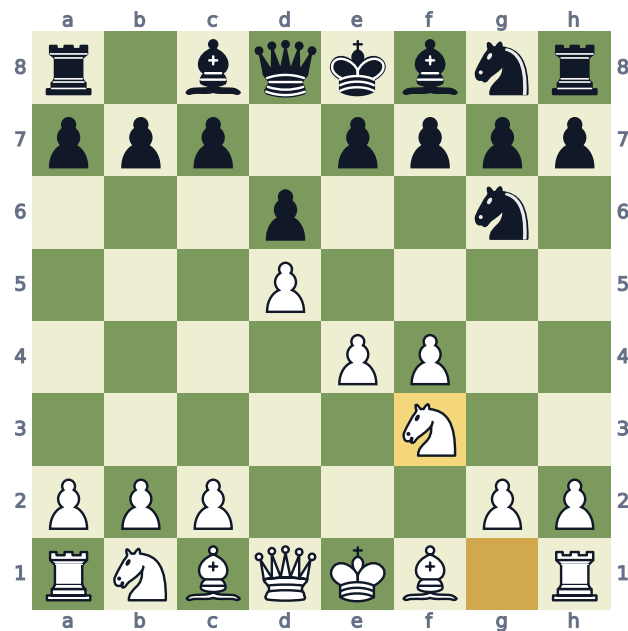
Too many pawn moves can expose dark squares and delay the king.

BRANCH LOGIC 12

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Chase the knight only when the center remains stable.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

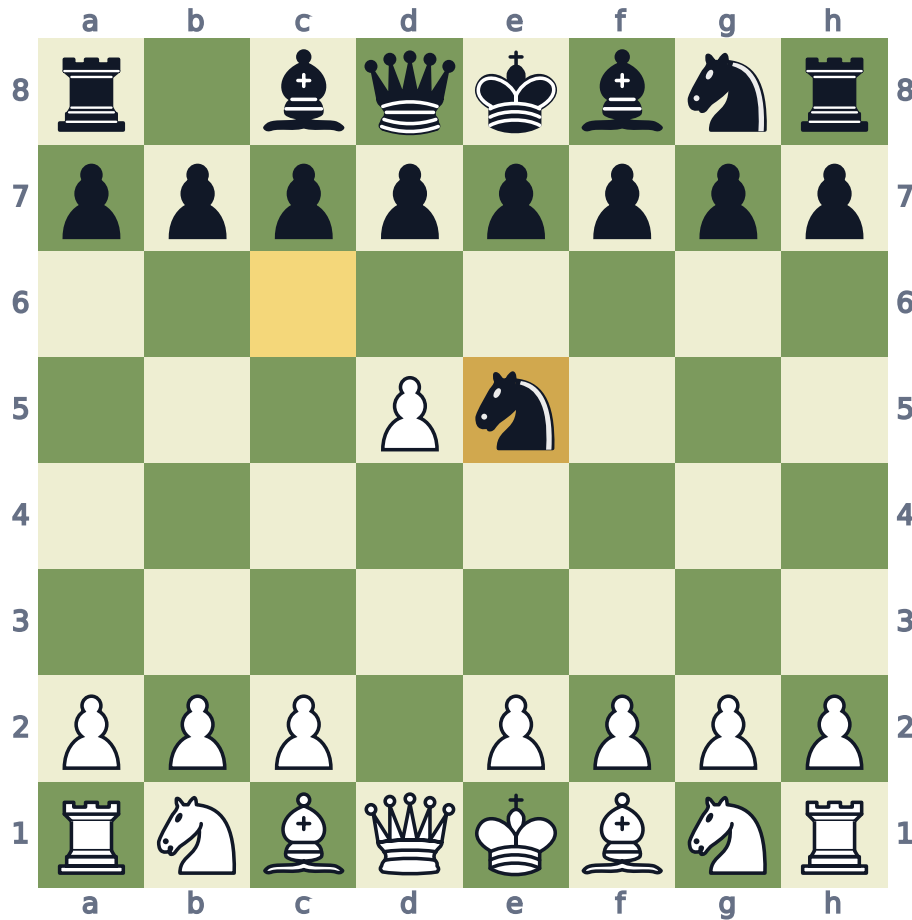
Position estimate: +1.32 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. e6 dxe6 2. fxe6 h4 3. Be7 g3 4. Nh6 Bh3 5. O-O Nc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 12

1...Nc6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 13

1...b5 Polish Defense



COURSE LINE

1. d4 b5 2. e4 Bb7 3. Bd3 f5 4. exf5 Bxg2 5. Qh5+

WHITE'S IDEA

Occupy the center and use tactics if Black attacks it prematurely.

MAIN DANGER

The sharp line requires exact checking geometry.

BRANCH LOGIC 13

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A flank pawn move gives White permission to claim the center, not to relax.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.44 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. g6 fxg6 2. Bg7 gxh7+ 3. Kf8 hxg8=R+ 4. Kxg8 Qg4 5. Bxh1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 13

1...b5 Polish Defense



YOUR TASK

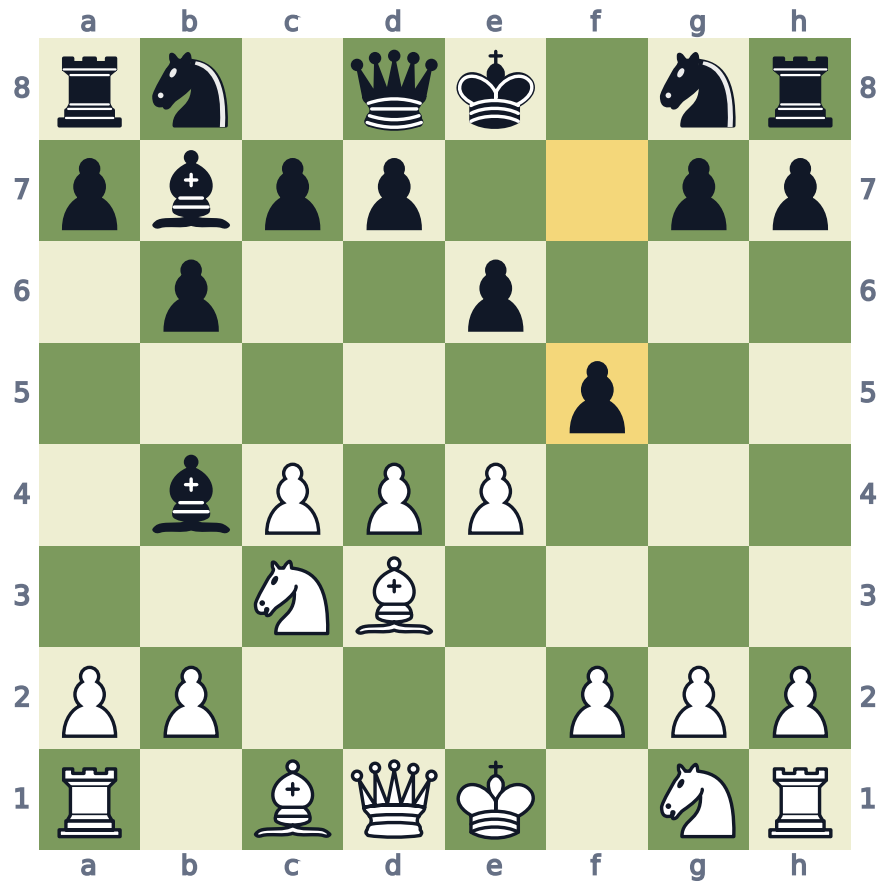
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 14

1...b6



COURSE LINE

1. d4 b6 2. c4 Bb7 3. Nc3 e6 4. e4 Bb4 5. Bd3 f5

WHITE'S IDEA

Use the same English Defense map and protect e4.

MAIN DANGER

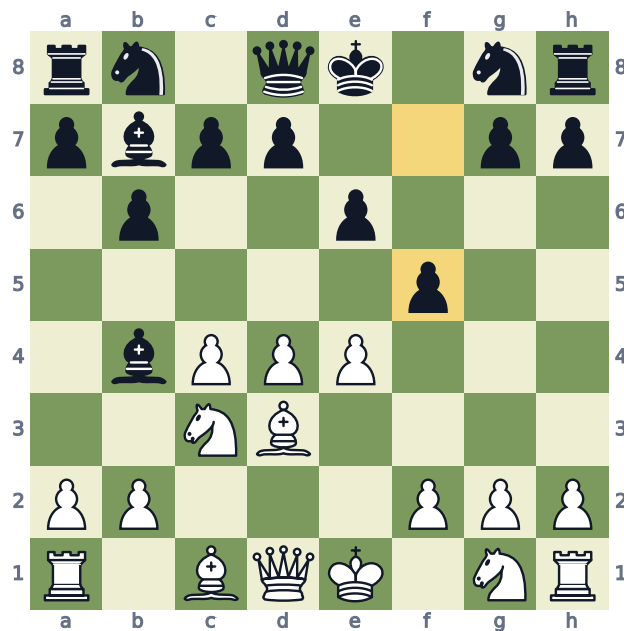
The long diagonal can punish a careless d5 or e5 push.

BRANCH LOGIC 14

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...b6 becomes meaningful only through pressure on e4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

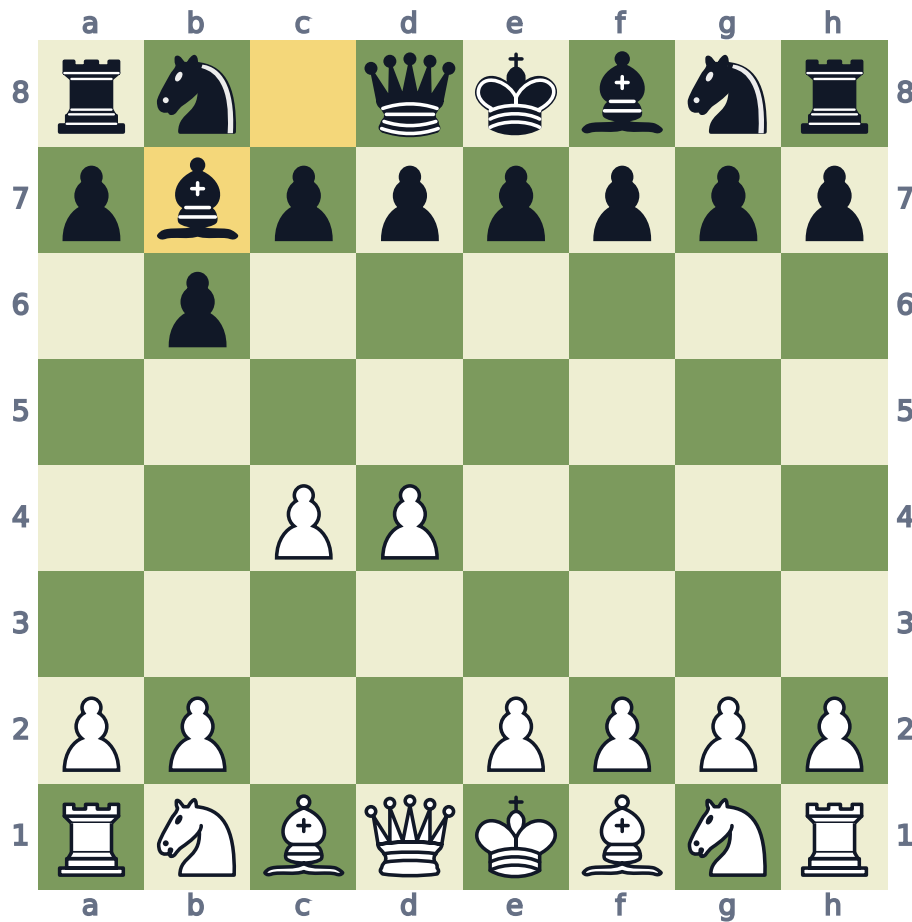
Position estimate: +0.65 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. f3 Qh4+ 2. g3 Qh5 3. exf5 Nc6 4. Ne2 Bxc3+ 5. bxc3 Qxf3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 14

1...b6



YOUR TASK

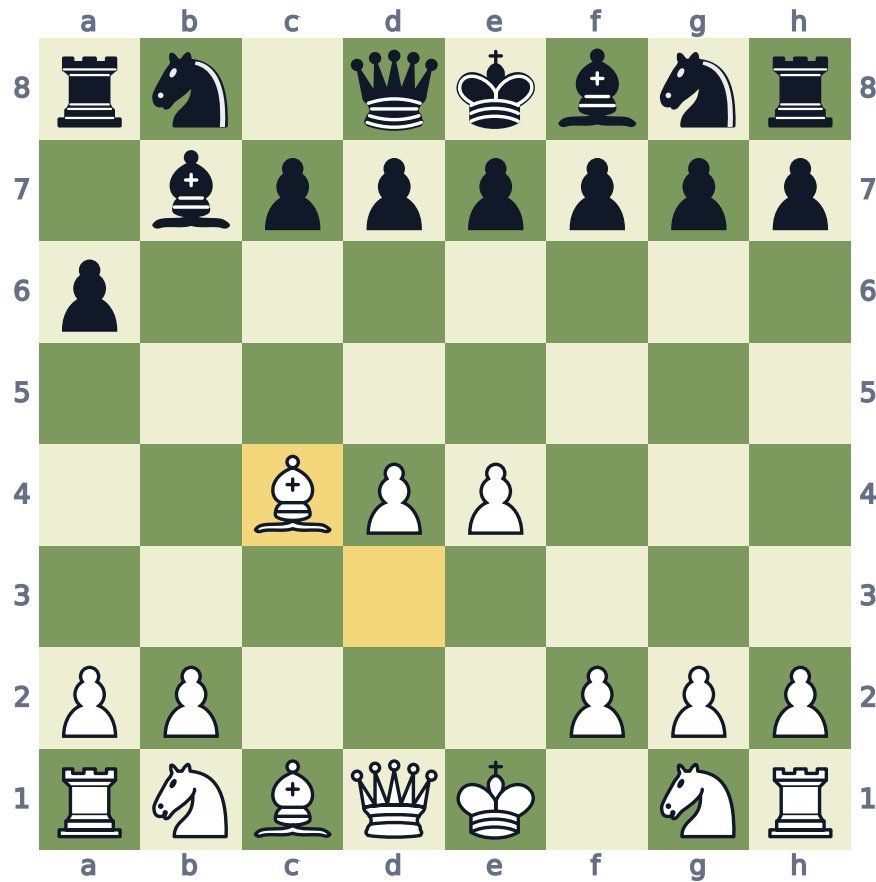
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 15

1...a6



COURSE LINE

1. d4 a6 2. c4 b5 3. e4 Bb7 4. Bd3 bxc4 5. Bxc4

WHITE'S IDEA

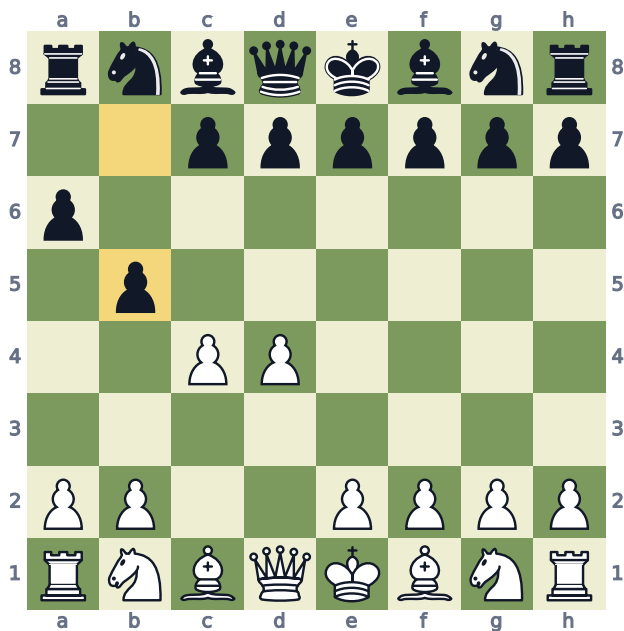
Take the center and answer queenside expansion with development.

MAIN DANGER

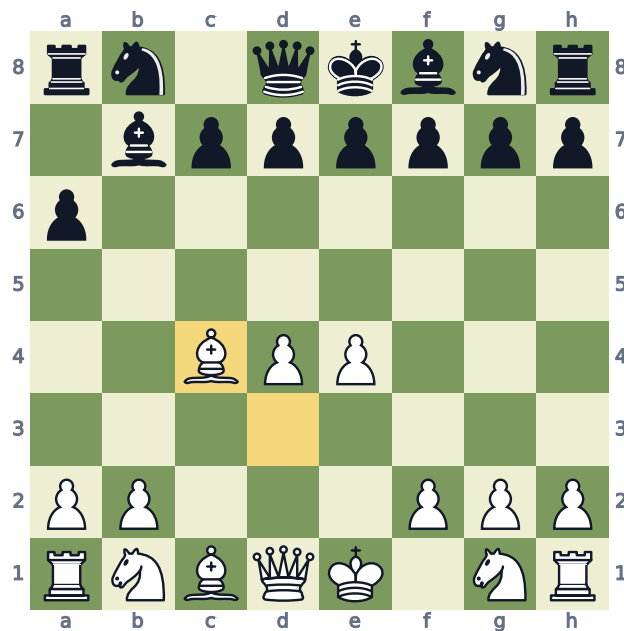
Overreacting to a wing pawn wastes the central advantage.

BRANCH LOGIC 15

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against a slow flank move, occupy the center and develop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.57 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bxe4 Nf3 2. e6 O-O 3. Bxf3 Qxf3 4. Nc6 d5 5. Ne5 Qe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 15

1...a6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. ENGLUND GAMBIT

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Develop with tempo and be ready to return the pawn to trap or displace the queen. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 f6 2. Bf4 g5 3. Bg3 fxe5 4. Nxe5 Bg7 5. Nxc6 bxc6 (+1.57 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: The b2-pawn is poisoned only if White knows the follow-up.

02. BUDAPEST GAMBIT

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Develop, meet the check, and return e5 if it completes development. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Nxe5 2. e3 g6 3. f4 Nec6 4. Nd5 Na6 (+0.67 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Trying to cling to e5 can leave the king in the center.

03. ALBIN COUNTERGAMBIT

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Blockade d4 and complete development before trying to win the pawn. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Nc6 2. Nf3 Nge7 3. Bg2 Ng6 4. Bg5 Qd7 5. O-O Ngxe5 (+0.75 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The advanced d4-pawn supports tactical checks and promotion tricks.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. CHIGORIN DEFENSE

Course move: cxd5. Purpose: Use the bishop pair and central space after forcing Black's queen to work. Engine comparison: 1. cxd5 Bxf3 2. gxf3 Qxd5 3. e3 Nf6 4. Bd2 O-O-O 5. Nc3 Qd7 (+0.71 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Doubled pawns require active pieces to justify them.

05. BALTIC DEFENSE

Course move: cxd5. Purpose: Exploit the early bishop move with a forcing check and development. Engine comparison: 1. cxd5 Bxb1 2. Rxb1 Qxd5 3. e3 e6 4. a3 Nd7 (+0.84 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: The rook on b1 can be exposed if the b-file opens.

06. ENGLISH DEFENSE

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Build the center but respect pressure on e4 and the long diagonal. Engine comparison: 1. e4 Bb4+ 2. Nc3 Bb7 3. Bd3 Bxc3+ 4. bxc3 d6 5. Ne2 Qh4 (+0.85 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: An overextended center can be attacked by ...f5 and ...Bxc3+.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-9

07. OLD INDIAN

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Build a classical center and use space before Black finds ...c6 or ...exd4. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 exd4 2. Nxd4 g6 3. e4 Bg7 4. f3 O-O 5. Be3 c5 (+0.61 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Closing too early can give Black an easy maneuvering plan.

08. BLACK KNIGHTS TANGO

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Use a3 to question ...Bb4 and transpose into a favorable central setup. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 e6 2. e4 d5 3. cxd5 exd5 4. e5 Ne4 5. Bb5 Bb4 (+0.67 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: a3 is useful only when it prevents a concrete pin or prepares b4.

09. MODERN DEFENSE MOVE ORDER

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Transpose into the Classical King's Indian structure without allowing unnecessary tricks. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Nf6 2. e4 O-O 3. h4 d6 4. Be2 h5 5. Bg5 c5 (+0.60 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black may delay ...Nf6 and strike with ...c5 or ...e5.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 10-12

10. WADE DEFENSE

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Occupy the center and complete development against a passive setup. Engine comparison: 1. e3 g6 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. e4 Bg7 5. d5 a5 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A large center can become a target after ...c6 and ...b5.

11. EARLY 1...C5

Course move: c4. Purpose: Transpose to the Benoni repertoire and use the same structure map. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 g6 2. e4 d6 3. h3 Bg7 4. Bd3 (+0.75 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Do not improvise a separate system when a known transposition is available.

12. 1...NC6

Course move: e4. Purpose: Gain space while developing and keep the pawn chain supported. Engine comparison: 1. f4 Ng6 2. f5 Ne5 3. e4 e6 4. Bf4 Bd6 5. Qd4 (+0.83 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: Too many pawn moves can expose dark squares and delay the king.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 13-15

13. 1...B5 POLISH DEFENSE

Course move: Bd3. Purpose: Occupy the center and use tactics if Black attacks it prematurely. Engine comparison: 1. Nd2 b4 2. Ngf3 e6 3. Bd3 Nf6 4. O-O Be7 5. Re1 d6 (+1.07 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: The sharp line requires exact checking geometry.

14. 1...B6

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use the same English Defense map and protect e4. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Nf6 2. Qc2 d5 3. cxd5 Nxd5 4. e4 Nxc3 5. bxc3 e5 (+0.75 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The long diagonal can punish a careless d5 or e5 push.

15. 1...A6

Course move: e4. Purpose: Take the center and answer queenside expansion with development. Engine comparison: 1. e4 e6 2. cxb5 Nf6 3. Nc3 Bb7 4. Bg5 h6 5. Bxf6 (+0.91 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: Overreacting to a wing pawn wastes the central advantage.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.